273 **'The wearing of gold and silk dresses':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 316.

274 **of his birthday:** Pooja Chaudhury, *A Study of Mughal Emperial Costumes and Designs during 16th and 17th Century*, PhD Thesis, Department of History, Aligarh Muslim University, 2015, p. 16.

274 **'it was a feast which the ancient Kings of Persia, who worshipped fire, used to celebrate':** Goldie, *The First Christian Mission to the Great Mogul*, p. 98.

274 **a tenth-century Ismaili writer that some Shias at court:** Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign*, p. 152.

274 **In 989 according to the decree of fate:** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 295.

275 **Abdur Rahim offered him jewels:** Shivram, 'Mughal Court Rituals: The Symbolism of Imperial Authority during Akbar's Reign', p. 343.

275 **quickly became an indispensable part of local cuisine:** Collingham, *Curry*, p. 28.

275 **led to a great deal of mystical experimentation in the sixteenth century:** For a comprehensive account of millennial history in India and Persia, see Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign.*

275 **'he inferred the known from the known and rejected also their predecessors':** Badauni, *Muntakhabh al-Tawarikh*, Vol. 2, p. 267.

275 **'everything that pleased him, he picked and chose from':** Ibid., p. 263.

276 **a number of subterranean streams of thinking in the sixteenth century:** For detailed analysis, see Hasan, *Religion, State and Society in Medieval India*; Habib (ed.), *Akbar and His India*, Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of* Akbar; Mukhia, *The Mughals in India*.

276 **'intellect (khirad)' would be elevated:** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of* Akbar, p. 162.

276 **'it is a remarkable thing that men should insist':** Stephen P. Blake, *Time in Early Modern Islam*, p. 101.

277 **'all religions are either equally true or equally illusory':** Khan, *India's Polity in the Age of Akbar*, p. 162.

277 **'an accepted code of ethical and legal behaviour':** Habib (ed.), *Akbar and His India*, p. 83.

278 **'conducted her himself to her palace in a gorgeous litter':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 205

278 **'[Akbar] never denyed [his mother] anything but this':** Thomas Coryat quoted in Mukhia, *The Mughals in India*, p. 14.

279 **'[H]is mother, his aunt, and many of the great lords':** du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*, p. 37.

279 **'whose intimate friend he had been':** Ibid., p. 226.

279 **'so covered with blood that drops were falling on the floor':** du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*, p. 226.

279 **'was always pondering in his mind':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 180.

279 **I perceive that there are varying customs and beliefs:** Ibid., p. 182.

280 **'began to suspect that he was intending to found a new religion':** Ibid., p. 184.

280 **'[T]he professors of various faiths had room in the broad expanse':** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 37.

280 **'the pearls of the Gospel to tread and crush under his feet':** Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*, p. 184.

280 **'The King, having a desire':** du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*, p. 36.

280 **'My father always associated with the learned of every creed and religion':** Rogers (trans.), *Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri*, p. 33.

280 **'I love you, Father':** du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits*, p. 38.